in them, in particular, the one that works towards reinforcing national states' (Marini 1977a:33. Author's translation).

In this regard, a dialectical process of internationalisation–internalisation is established in which state consolidation in sub-imperialist states acts in a way that is contradictory to the internationalisation process, as an element guaranteeing the integration of productive systems. 'If the export of capital coming from national imperialism marks the moment when the tendency for capital to expand internationally is revealed in a pure form, then its decisive transformation into productive capital within a domestic economy represents the moment of its negation when this capital begins to depend upon the capacity of this economy – and, therefore, of the state that governs it – to guarantee its reproduction' (Marini 1977a:33. Author's translation).

Given the dimension of the disadvantages existing between the imperialist bourgeoisie and that of dependent countries, the latter find themselves lacking the conditions to negotiate directly with imperialism, a position beneficial to their decision to associate with the integrationist tendency imposed by imperialist centres. Because of this they 'opt for consolidating the national state as an intermediary'. That option allows them to focus on organising their forces. This intermediation, when combined with emphasis on the capital concentration and centralisation process that has now reached dependent economies, facilitates 'the reproduction in these countries of the phenomenon of agglomeration of capital with the national state, to which Bukharin alludes, involving as much national as well as foreign capital'. The result of this agglomeration 'is not the simple and pure submission of the state to capital'. On the contrary:

> Although if it is evident that the state is transformed into what Bukharin calls a 'national capitalist trust,' the very fact that it is obliged to order and arbitrate economic life (as far as its arbitration is compatible with its subordination to imperialist states) places it in a situation in which its relative autonomy in the face of distinct capitalist groups is highlighted … It was in relation to this that the Brazilian state was able to formulate a plan that was not one with a sub-imperialist structure but was a sub-imperialist policy with a much greater degree of rationality than that which the national and foreign capital operating in Brazil could give it (Marini 1977a:34. Author's translation).

In this way, the state is there both to ensure the better reproduction of imperial capitalist investment and to preserve a relative autonomy in front of foreign